

Health & Safety Policy

SECTION 1: PURPOSE

1 PURPOSE

The purpose of this Health & Safety Policy is to establish and maintain a safe and healthy environment for all service users, staff, visitors, and contractors at Chosanta Management.

This policy ensures compliance with the Safety, Health and Welfare at Work Act 2005 and relevant HIQA standards. It outlines the organisation's commitment to preventing injury and ill health, promoting wellbeing, and ensuring that all health and safety risks are assessed and managed effectively.

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SECTION 2: SCOPE

2 SCOPE

This Health & Safety Policy applies to:

- ✓ All employees, management, and contractors of Chosanta Management
- ✓ All service users residing in the organisation's facilities
- ✓ All visitors, volunteers, and others who may be affected by the organisation's activities

It covers all premises operated by the organisation, including HIQA-registered residential care homes, emergency placements, and any auxiliary buildings or offices.

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SECTION 3: RESPONSIBILITIES

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

3.1 Management:

- ✓ Ensure compliance with health and safety legislation and best practice
- ✓ Provide appropriate resources for health and safety, including training and protective equipment
- ✓ Conduct risk assessments and ensure safety controls are implemented
- ✓ Investigate incidents and take corrective action where necessary

3.2 Staff:

- ✓ Take reasonable care for their own health and safety and that of others
- ✓ Follow all safety protocols and procedures
- ✓ Report hazards, near misses, or accidents promptly
- ✓ Participate in required health and safety training

3.3 Service Users:

- ✓ Are encouraged to follow house rules that promote safety
- ✓ Are supported to understand and participate in safety measures relevant to their environment

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SECTION 4: RISK ASSESSMENT & HAZARD CONTROL

4 RISK ASSESSMENT & HAZARD CONTROL

Chosanta Management carries out regular and systematic risk assessments to identify, evaluate, and manage potential hazards. All risk assessments are documented and reviewed regularly, especially following incidents or changes in operations.

Control measures include:

- ✓ Use of personal protective equipment (PPE)
- ✓ Staff training and supervision
- ✓ Environmental controls and safety signage
- ✓ Emergency preparedness and planning
- ✓ House-wide risk register reviewed monthly
- ✓ Any new hazard logged and controlled within 24 hours
- ✓ Risk assessments carried out on all rooms and equipment

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SECTION 5: ACCIDENT & INCIDENT REPORTING

5 ACCIDENT & INCIDENT REPORTING

All accidents, near misses, and incidents must be reported and documented in a timely and accurate manner to ensure legal compliance, ongoing safety improvements, and risk reduction.

- ✓ Immediate reporting to the Person in Charge or designated safety officer
- ✓ Completion of the Incident Report Form within 24 hours
- ✓ Prompt medical attention where required
- ✓ Investigation of root causes and contributing factors
- ✓ Implementation of corrective and preventative measures
- ✓ Serious incidents reported to external authorities (e.g., HIQA, HSA, or Tusla) in line with legal requirements
- ✓ All reports reviewed and stored securely for learning, trend analysis, and audit

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SECTION 6: FIRE SAFETY

6 FIRE SAFETY

Chosanta Management is committed to ensuring the highest standards of fire safety across all facilities, in compliance with fire regulations, HIQA requirements, and local authority guidelines.

- ✓ Regular fire safety risk assessments
- ✓ Maintenance and inspection of fire detection and alarm systems
- ✓ Clearly marked fire exits and escape routes
- ✓ Fire extinguishers placed in accessible areas and serviced regularly
- ✓ Emergency lighting in corridors and communal spaces
- ✓ Display of evacuation plans in key locations
- ✓ Training for all staff in fire prevention, evacuation procedures, and use of extinguishers
- ✓ Fire drills conducted at least quarterly; PEEPs in place for all service users requiring assistance

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SECTION 7: MANUAL HANDLING & ERGONOMICS

7 MANUAL HANDLING & ERGONOMICS

Chosanta Management recognises the risks associated with manual handling and poor ergonomic practices. All staff involved in physical activities must be trained in safe manual handling techniques.

- ✓ Completion of Manual Handling and Patient Handling training for all relevant staff
- ✓ Use of mechanical aids (e.g., hoists, trolleys) to minimise strain
- ✓ Proper posture and lifting techniques promoted through ongoing training
- ✓ Workstations and equipment set up to reduce musculoskeletal strain
- ✓ Regular reviews of ergonomic practices to ensure compliance and comfort
- ✓ Equipment assessed before use; repositioning aids used where needed

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SECTION 8: INFECTION CONTROL

8 INFECTION CONTROL

To safeguard the health and wellbeing of service users and staff, Chosanta Management implements robust infection prevention and control procedures aligned with HSE and HIQA standards.

- ✓ Routine hand hygiene and use of hand sanitiser
- ✓ Appropriate use and disposal of personal protective equipment (PPE)
- ✓ Regular cleaning and disinfection of high-touch surfaces; daily sanitisation
- ✓ Isolation protocols for individuals showing symptoms of infectious conditions
- ✓ Safe handling of waste, laundry, and sharps
- ✓ Staff training in standard and transmission-based precautions; hand hygiene training completed quarterly
- ✓ PPE available on-site at all times; outbreak response plans in place for rapid containment

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SECTION 9: MENTAL HEALTH & WELLBEING

9 MENTAL HEALTH & WELLBEING

Chosanta Management recognises the importance of mental health and emotional wellbeing in a safe and healthy workplace. The organisation is committed to promoting a supportive environment where staff and service users can thrive.

- ✓ Promoting open communication and a culture of mutual respect
- ✓ Providing access to Employee Assistance Programmes (EAPs) or counselling support
- ✓ Encouraging work-life balance and stress-reducing practices
- ✓ Identifying and reducing psychosocial risks in the workplace
- ✓ Providing mental health training to staff to recognise signs of distress in themselves or others

Mental wellbeing is integrated into health and safety planning and supported through regular staff supervision and feedback mechanisms.

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SECTION 10: MONITORING, AUDIT, FIRST AID & LONE WORKING

10 MONITORING & AUDIT

- ✓ Scheduled internal audits of health and safety systems
- ✓ Monthly inspections by management or health & safety representatives
- ✓ Incident reviews and analysis to identify trends or recurring risks
- ✓ Service user and staff feedback on safety conditions
- ✓ Action plans developed and tracked to address audit findings

+ FIRST AID & EMERGENCY PROCEDURES

- ✓ First aid kits in every unit, checked weekly
- ✓ Named First Aiders rostered per shift
- ✓ Emergency numbers clearly posted

■ LONE WORKING POLICY

- ✓ No staff permitted to lone work with children
- ✓ In exceptional cases, live phone check-in every 30 minutes
- ✓ Lone work risk assessment filed and signed by Manager

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SECTION 11: POLICY REVIEW & SAFETY TRAINING

11 POLICY REVIEW

This Health & Safety Policy is reviewed annually or more frequently if there are significant changes in operations, regulations, or following an incident that requires policy revision.

- ✓ Ensuring the policy remains compliant with relevant legislation and standards
- ✓ Consulting with staff and service users on safety issues and incorporating feedback
- ✓ Updating risk assessments, training materials, and procedures as needed
- ✓ Review dates and version control documented clearly; all staff informed of changes

SAFETY TRAINING RECORDS

- ✓ Manual handling, fire safety, infection control, and PMAV training tracked
- ✓ Certificates retained in HR file
- ✓ Expiry dates monitored by admin monthly